



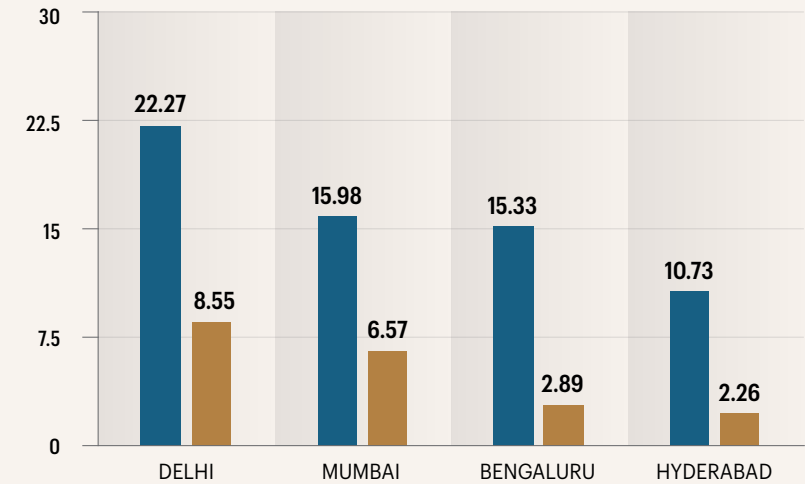
“Yes, turbulence is in the nature of aviation. But Indian aviation is poised for what I call the golden age. The next five years are going to be incredible”

HARI MARAR

MD & CEO, BANGALORE INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LTD

PASSENGER MOVEMENT

• Delhi leads with 30.8 million passengers between April and August 2025—the highest among metros



● DOMESTIC (IN MILLION) ● INTERNATIONAL (IN MILLION)
NOTE DATA FOR APRIL TO AUGUST 2025 **SOURCE** AAI

dustrial & Infrastructure Development Corporation Ltd and Airports Authority of India hold 13% each.

The rapid pace of passenger traffic growth has fueled BIAL’s ambition to make the airport a hub for passengers from India and beyond to destinations further afield.

The airport closed the last financial year with 42 million passengers, and is expected to exceed 48 million this year, of which around 7 to 7.5 million will be international travellers—a 50% jump in overseas traffic in just “two to three years,” says Marar. By 2030, he expects the number to climb to 70–80 million passengers.

Terminal 2, hailed as a show-piece of green architecture and design, has the capacity to handle 10 million international travellers, expandable to 12 million. Phase 2 of its construction is under way, which will double capacity to 20

million in five to six years.

“It is about convergence. We’re not just seeing more airports being built; existing ones like Bengaluru and Mumbai are expanding. And airlines like IndiGo and Air India have placed massive aircraft orders,” says analyst Jitendra Bhargava. “Why should we doubt that aviation won’t grow?”

FINANCIAL DEMANDS

To be sure, financial demands on BIAL to power such growth will be heavy. The next phase of expansion alone is expected to cost between ₹16,000 crore and ₹20,000 crore.

Marar insists that BIAL is well prepared. Equity requirements will be partly met through retained earnings amassed over the past few years. With an ‘AAA’ credit rating, strong cash flows, and longstanding creditor relationships, the

company is confident of securing financing on favourable terms to cover the remainder.

BIAL is looking beyond terminals and runways. With its existing two-runway system, it can eventually handle more than 100 million passengers a year, albeit with some constraints. To help it overcome them, the company has expressed interest in participating in the development of Bengaluru’s proposed second airport, planned to be functional some time between 2031 and 2035.

“We maintain a strong relationship with the Karnataka government, which also owns a 13% stake in us,” says Marar. He insists that this will not overstretch BIAL because the airport’s expansion should be completed by 2029 or 2030, well before the new airport project gathers pace.

And Marar believes India’s